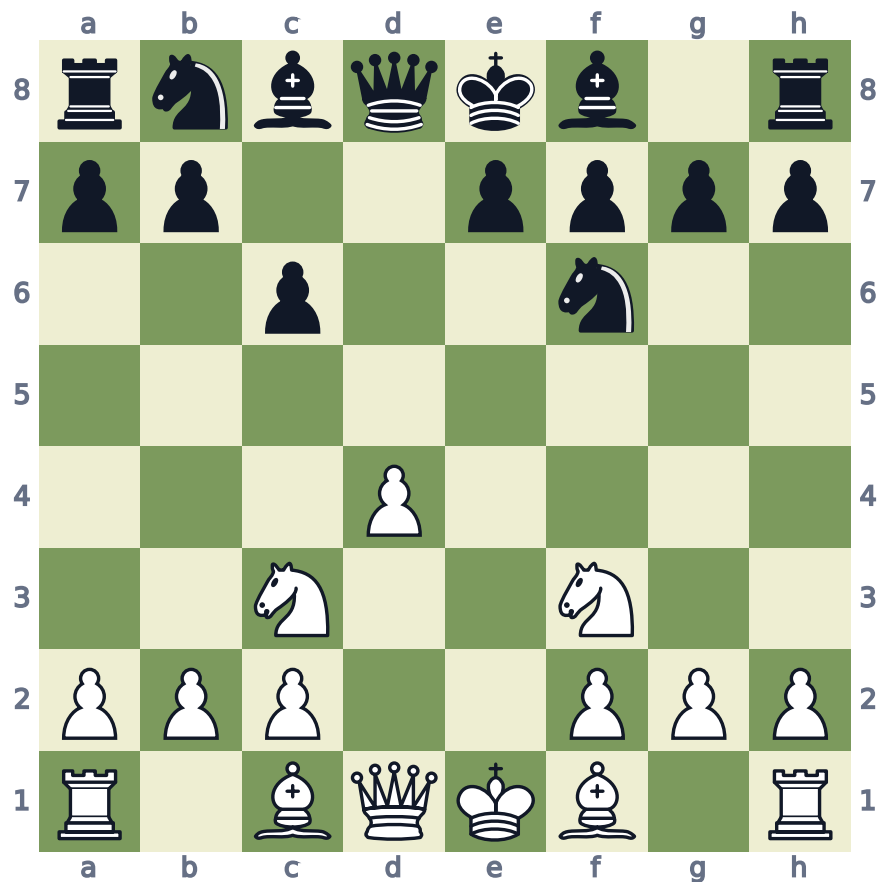


Scandinavian and Alekhine Repertoire

Queen-development tempi, central occupation, provocative knight play, and anti-center counterattacks



Meet 1...d5 and 1...Nf6 with principled central play while avoiding the tactical shortcuts these defenses invite.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Meet 1...d5 and 1...Nf6 with principled central play while avoiding the tactical shortcuts these defenses invite.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Capturing on d5 is sound because development can chase the exposed queen.

PRINCIPLE 2

Nc3 gains time but must not block a necessary c-pawn plan without thought.

PRINCIPLE 3

Against 2...Nf6, Black offers temporary material for development.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Alekhine's Defense provokes pawns forward and attacks their base.

PRINCIPLE 5

A large center must be supported by pieces.

PRINCIPLE 6

Do not chase a queen or knight beyond the point where development suffers.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

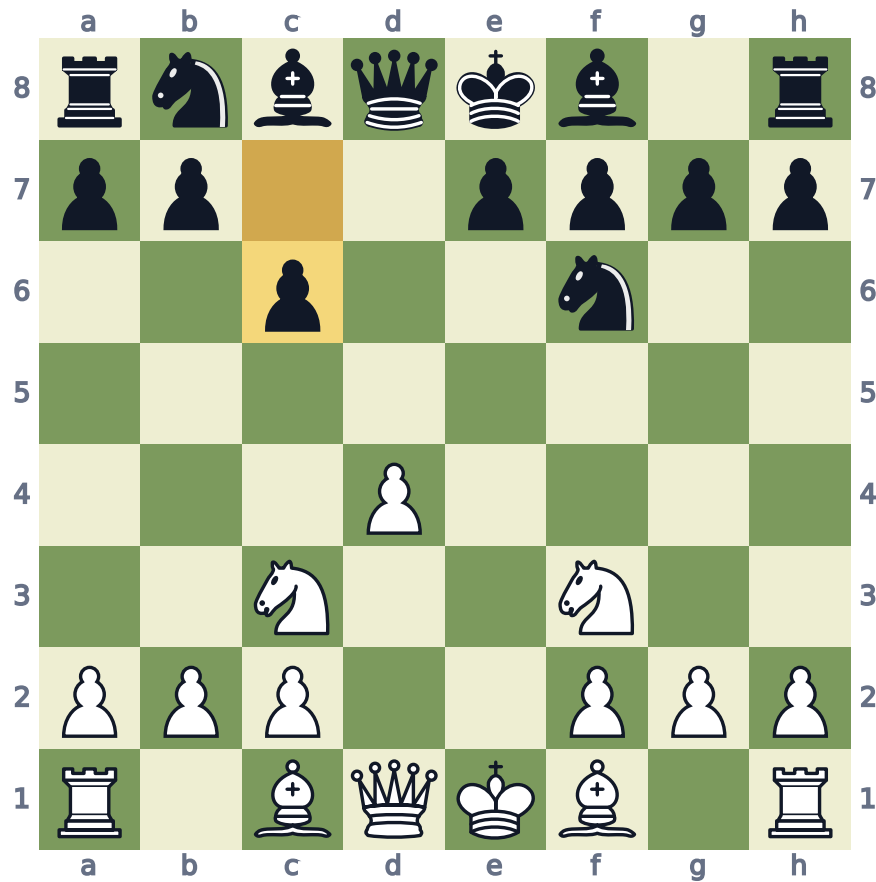
- | | | |
|-----------|----------------------------|---|
| 01 | Scandinavian ...Qd8 | After the queen retreats, the advantage is easier development, not material. |
| 02 | Scandinavian ...Qa5 | Against ...Qa5, avoid moving the c3 knight before the pin is resolved. |
| 03 | Scandinavian ...Qd6 | Do not chase ...Qd6 if development gives a larger gain. |
| 04 | Modern Scandinavian | Against 2...Nf6, defend the pawn only when development remains healthy. |
| 05 | Icelandic Gambit | The gambit is about development; neutralize it with development. |
| 06 | Portuguese Gambit | Against ...Bg4, decide whether f3 or Be2 better serves development. |
| 07 | Alekhine Modern | Nf3 develops before another pawn advance and keeps the center coordinated. |
| 08 | Alekhine Four Pawns | Use this as a structure lesson; the Modern line is the safer main repertoire. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Scandinavian ...Qd8



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Nc3 Qd8 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 c6

WHITE'S IDEA

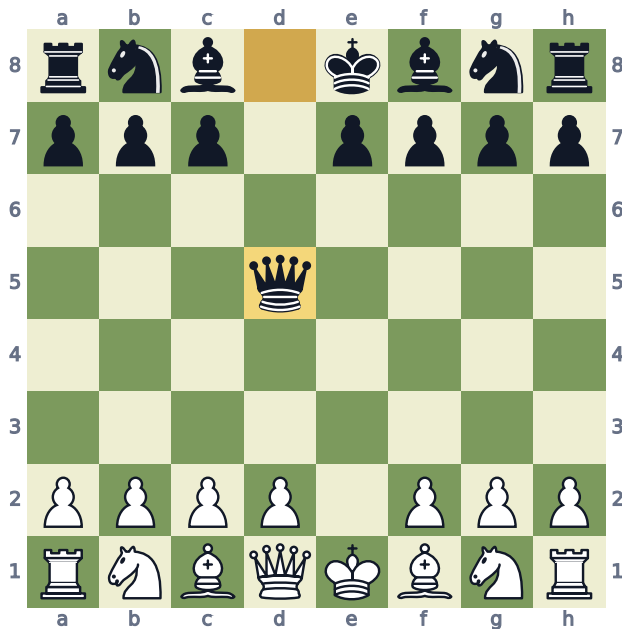
Use the development tempo to build a healthy center and castle.

MAIN DANGER

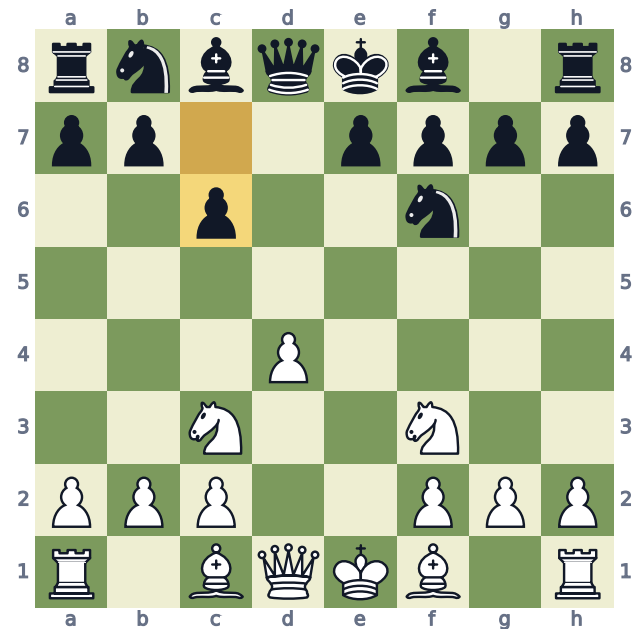
Do not waste the gained tempo on unnecessary pawn moves.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

After the queen retreats, the advantage is easier development, not material.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

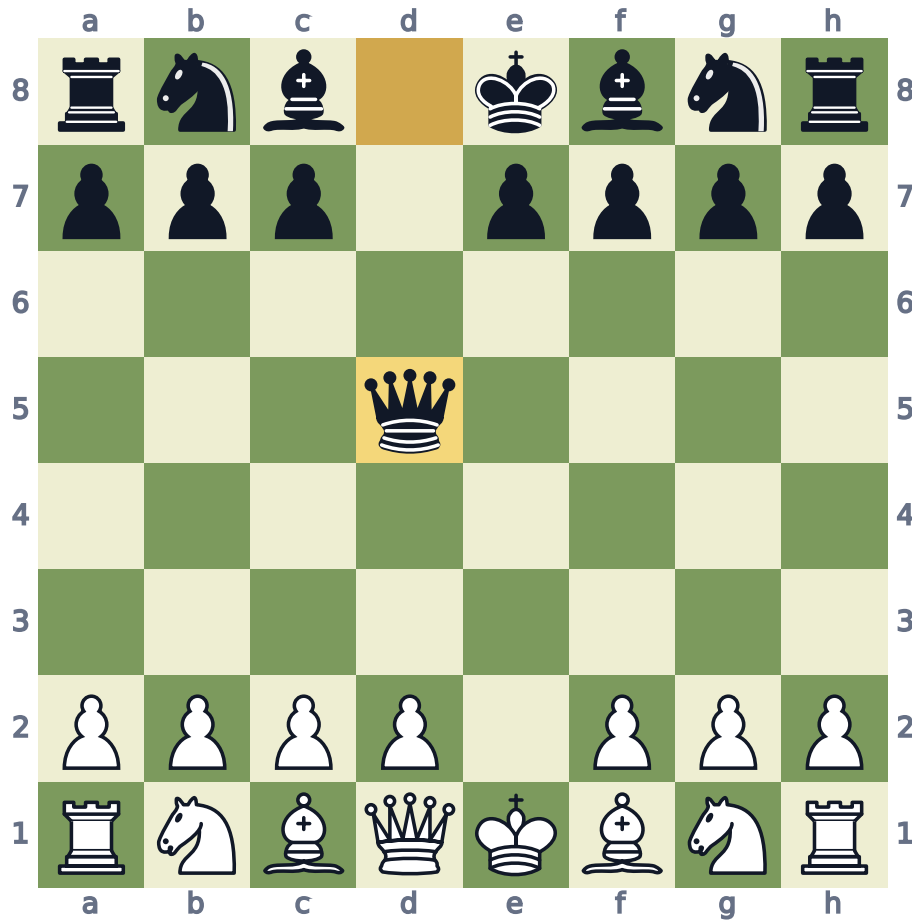
Position estimate: +1.01 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bc4 Nbd7 2. O-O e6 3. Qe2 Be7 4. a4 a5 5. Re1 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Scandinavian ...Qd8



YOUR TASK

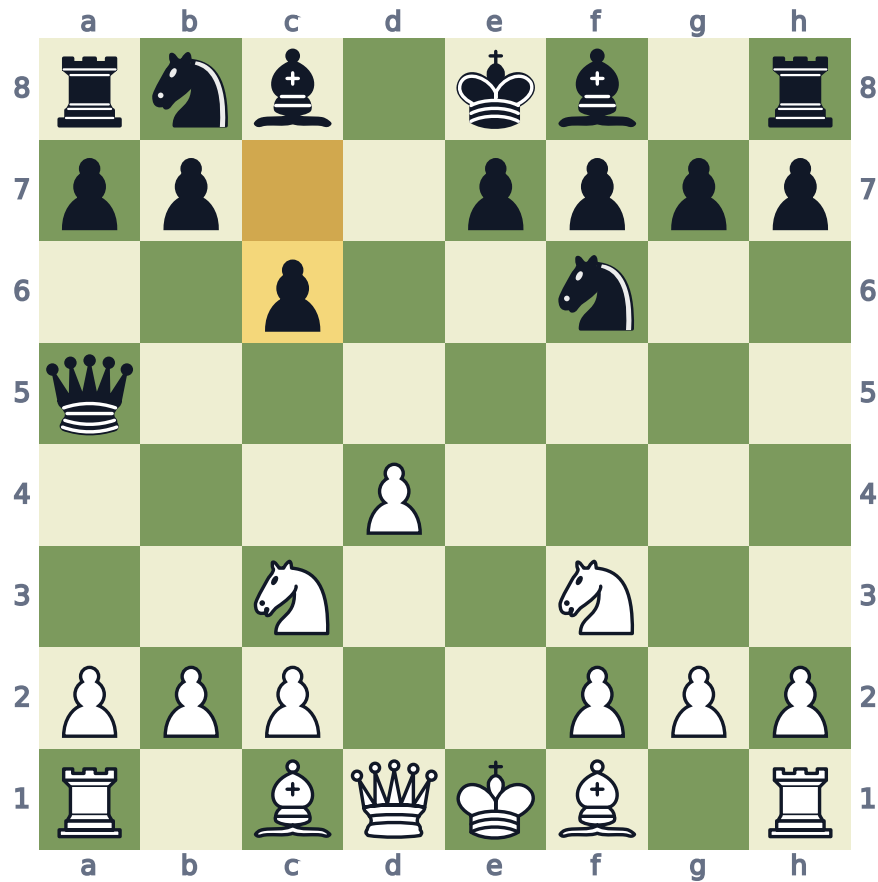
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Scandinavian ...Qa5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Nc3 Qa5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 c6

WHITE'S IDEA

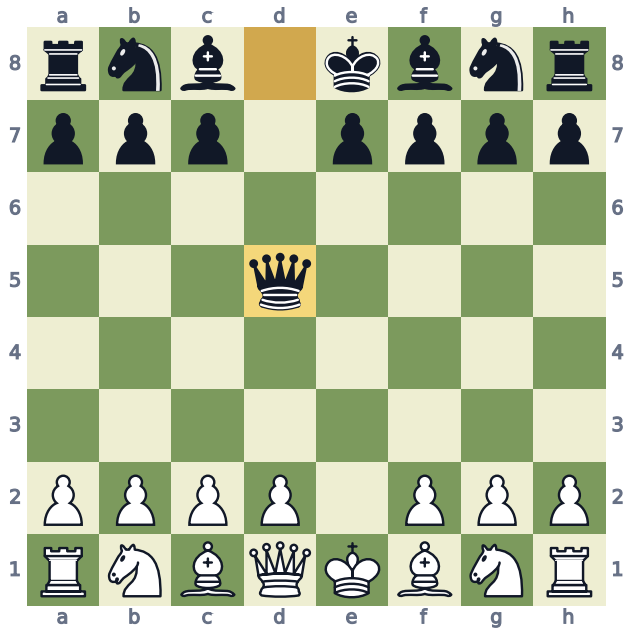
Develop while watching the pin on c3 and pressure on d4.

MAIN DANGER

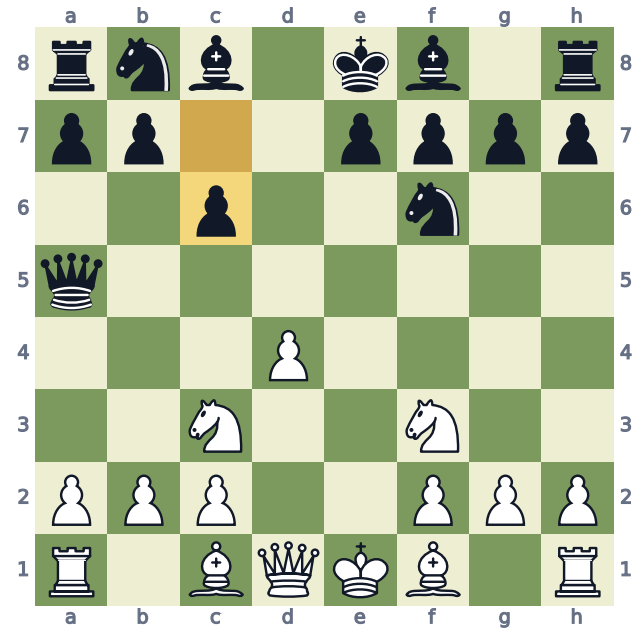
The queen can support ...e5 or ...Bf5 with tactical pressure.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...Qa5, avoid moving the c3 knight before the pin is resolved.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

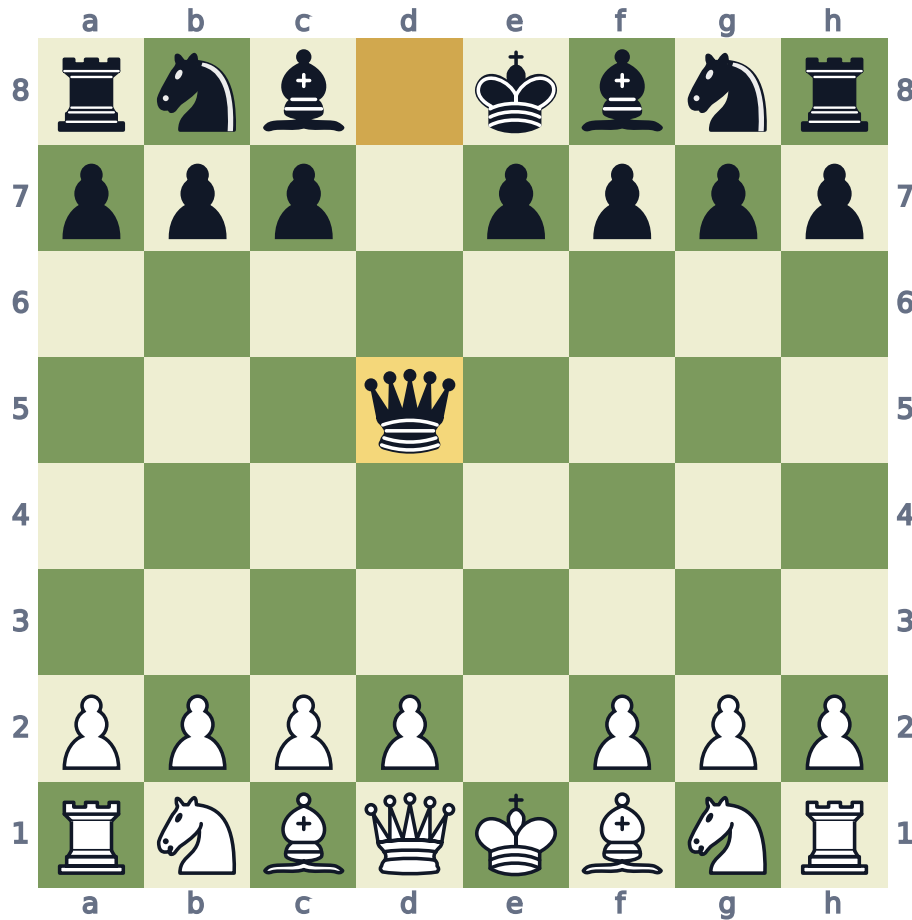
Position estimate: +0.72 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bc4 Bg4 2. h3 Bxf3 3. Qxf3 Nbd7 4. Bd2 Qb6 5. O-O-O Qxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Scandinavian ...Qa5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Scandinavian ...Qd6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Nc3 Qd6 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 c6

WHITE'S IDEA

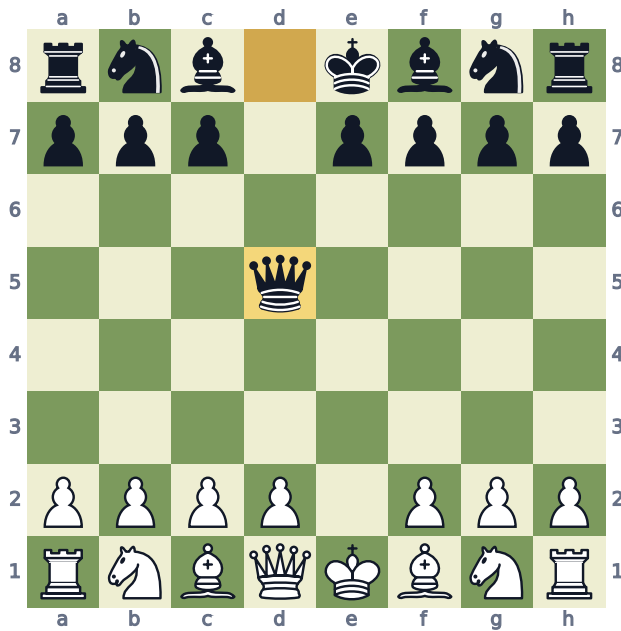
Gain space and use natural development against the centralized queen.

MAIN DANGER

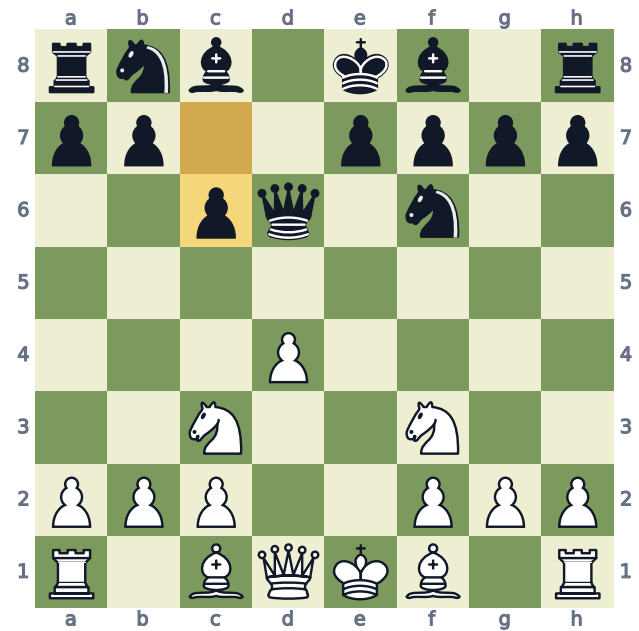
The queen may support ...e5 and kingside castling.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Do not chase ...Qd6 if development gives a larger gain.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

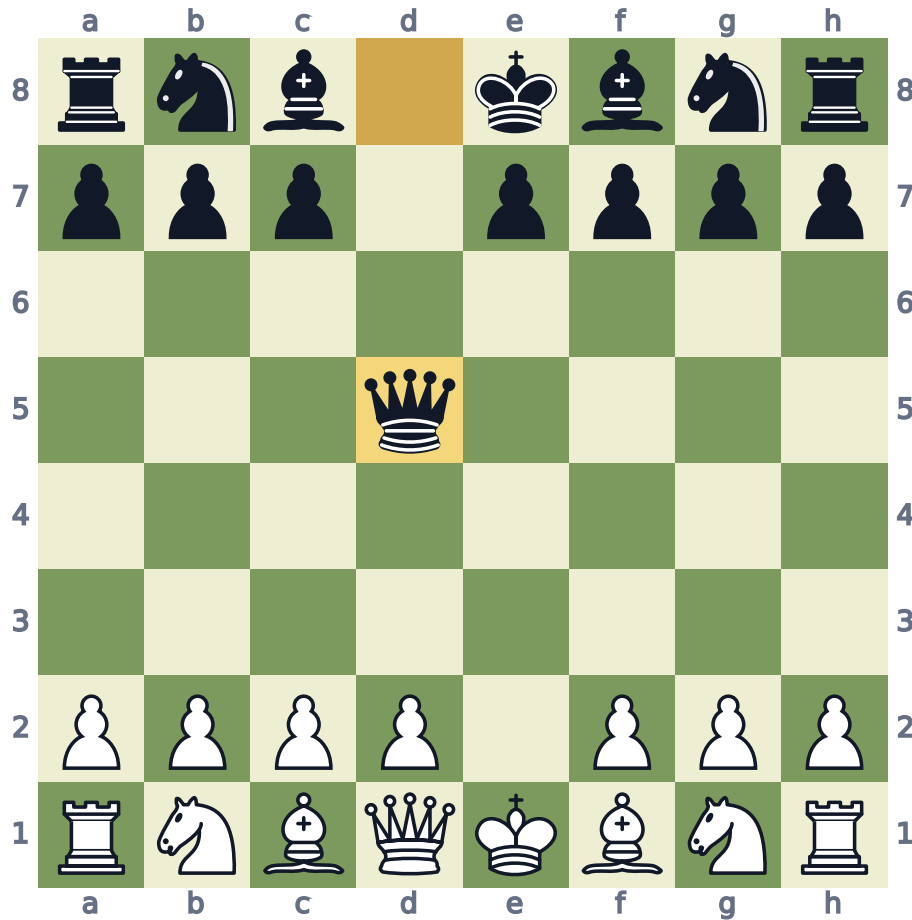
Position estimate: +0.71 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Ne5 Be6 2. Be2 g6 3. Bf4 Qd8 4. a4 Bg7 5. a5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Scandinavian ...Qd6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Modern Scandinavian



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Nf6 3. d4 Nxd5 4. Nf3 g6 5. c4 Nb6

WHITE'S IDEA

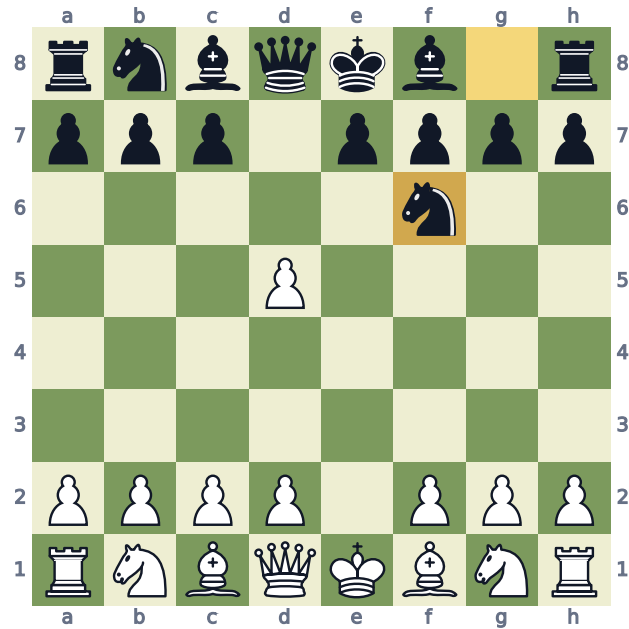
Build the center and gain time against the knight.

MAIN DANGER

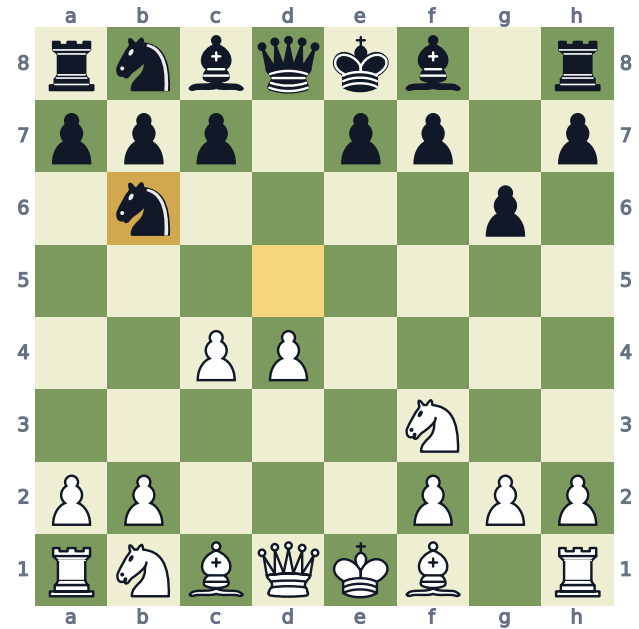
c4 creates d4 and dark-square obligations.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against 2...Nf6, defend the pawn only when development remains healthy.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

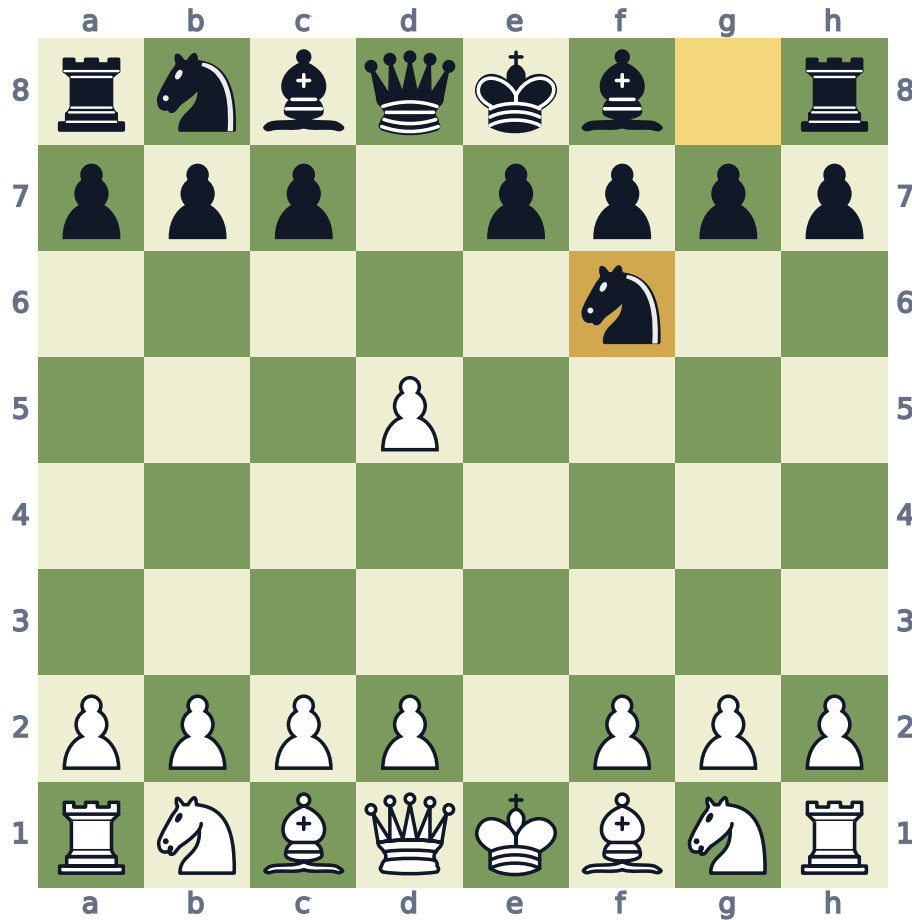
Position estimate: +0.89 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc3 Bg7 2. h3 Nc6 3. Be3 O-O 4. Be2 e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Modern Scandinavian



YOUR TASK

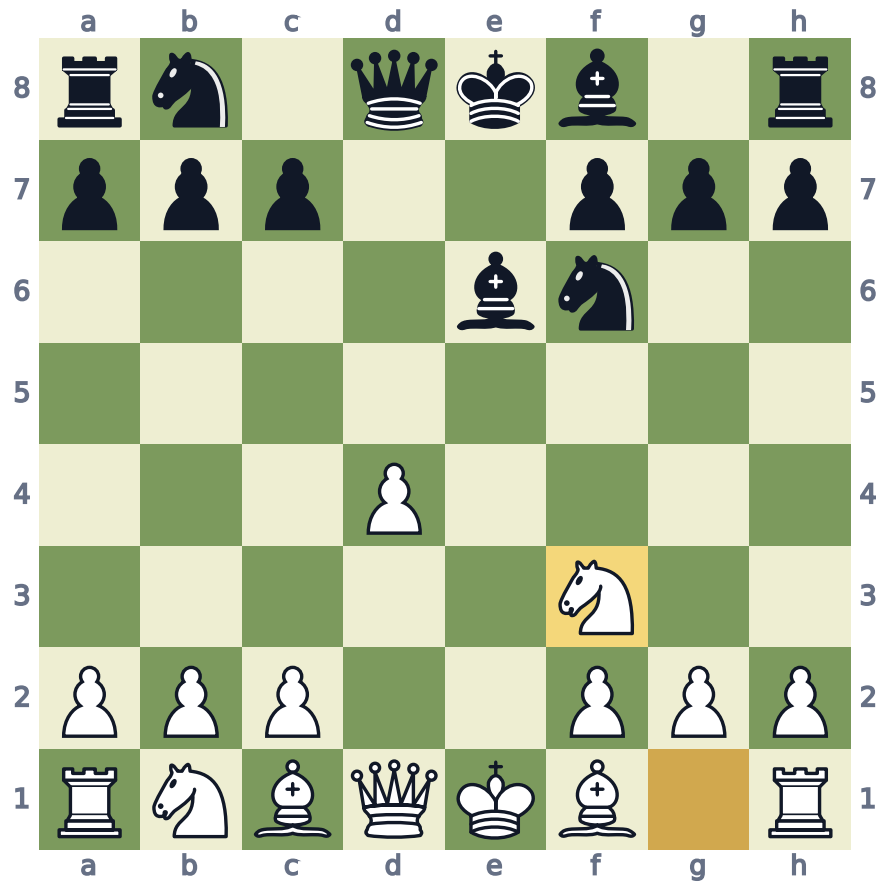
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Icelandic Gambit



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Nf6 3. d4 e6 4. dxe6 Bxe6 5. Nf3

WHITE'S IDEA

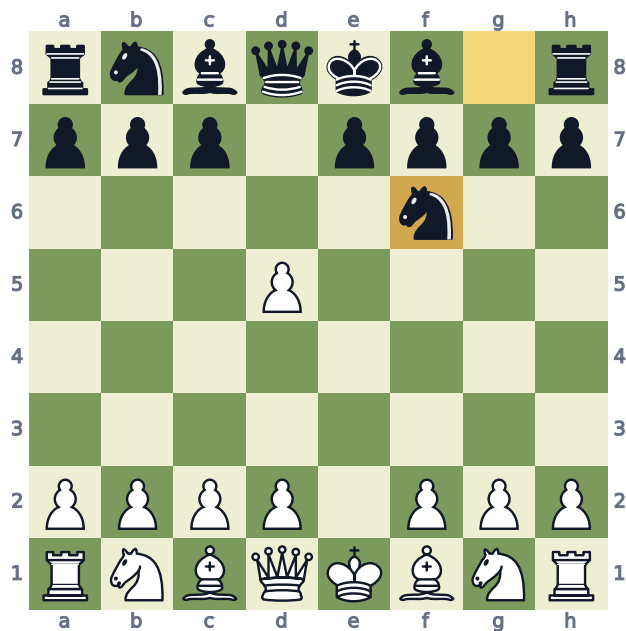
Return or keep material only while completing development and protecting the king.

MAIN DANGER

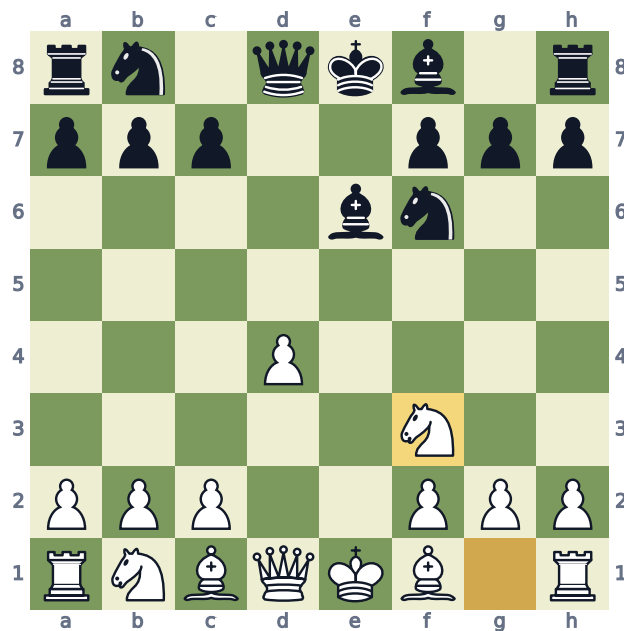
Black's bishops and open lines give dangerous initiative.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The gambit is about development; neutralize it with development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

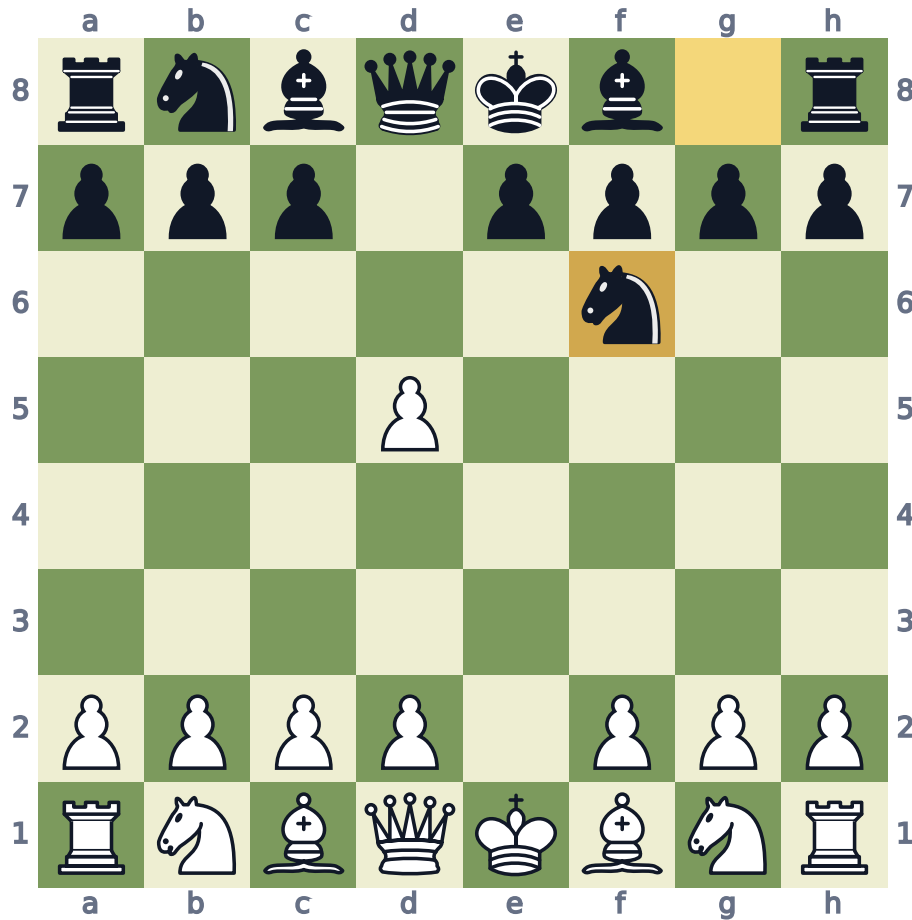
Position estimate: +1.25 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. c5 Bb5+ 2. Nc6 O-O 3. Be7 dxc5 4. Bxc5 Qxd8+ 5. Rxd8 Bxc6+

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Icelandic Gambit



YOUR TASK

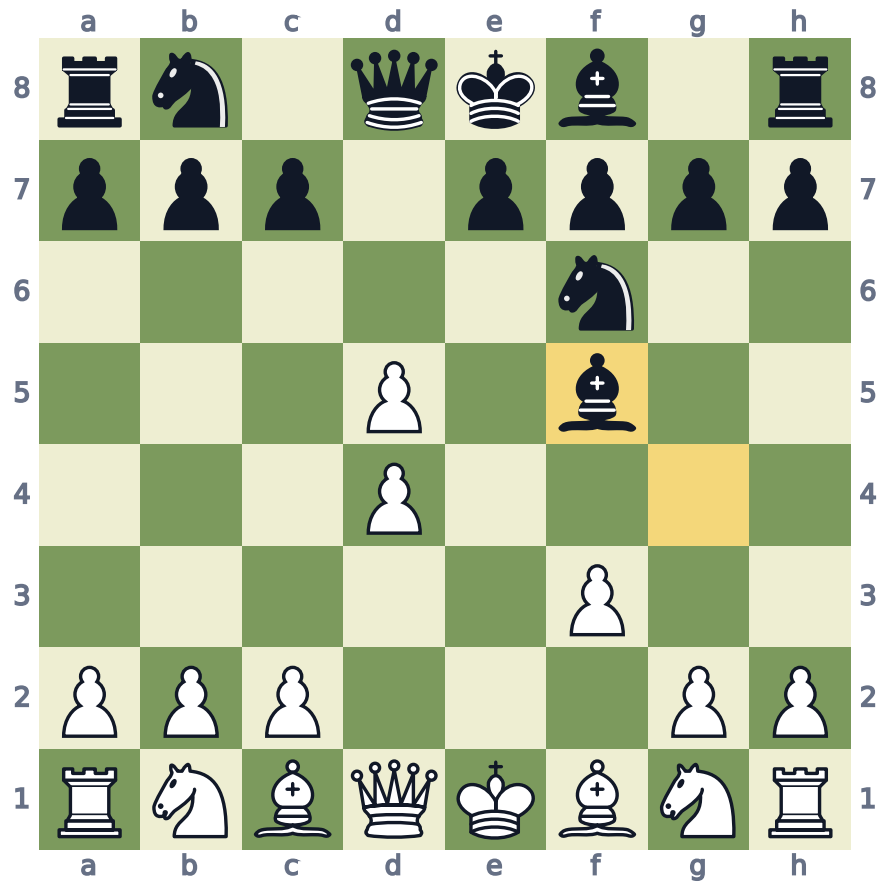
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Portuguese Gambit



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d5 2. exd5 Nf6 3. d4 Bg4 4. f3 Bf5

WHITE'S IDEA

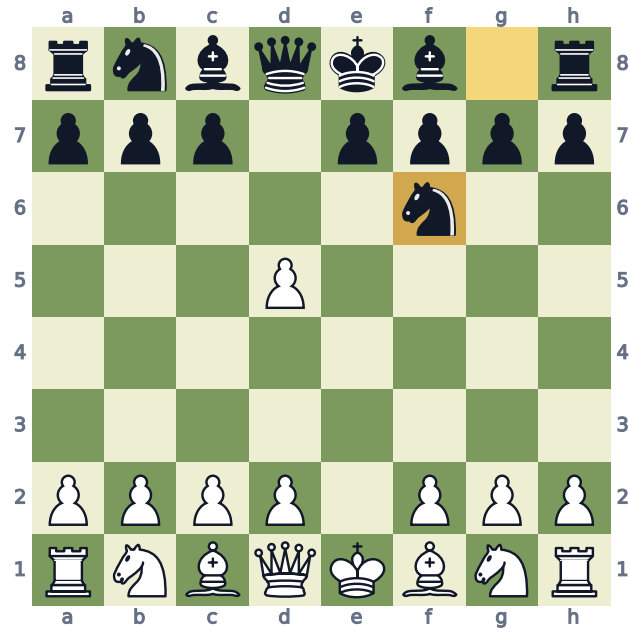
Question the bishop and keep the extra pawn flexible.

MAIN DANGER

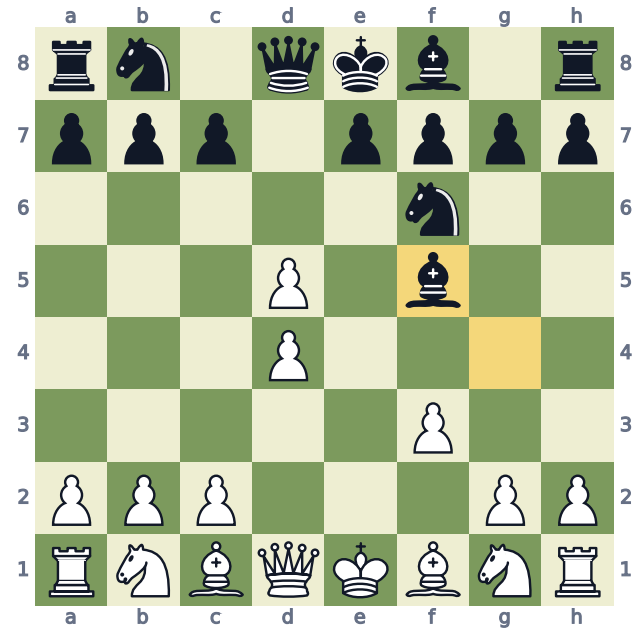
f3 weakens the king and e3 square.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...Bg4, decide whether f3 or Be2 better serves development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

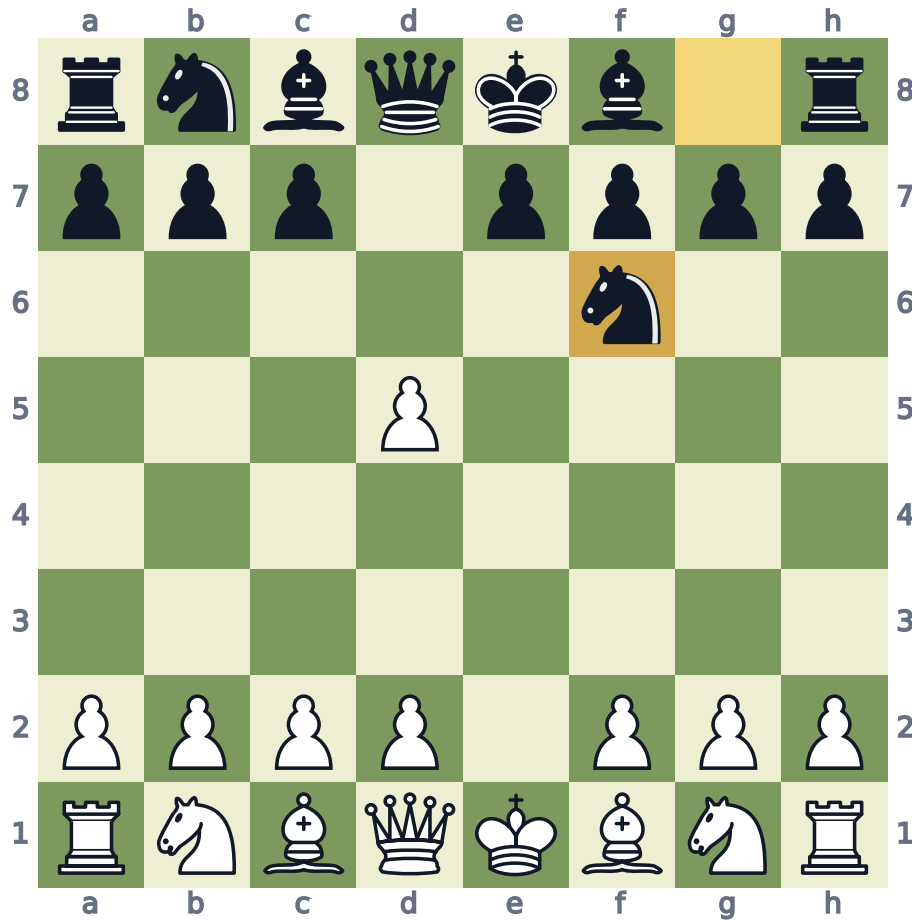
Position estimate: +0.98 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. g4 Bg6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 exd5 4. g5 Nh5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Portuguese Gambit



YOUR TASK

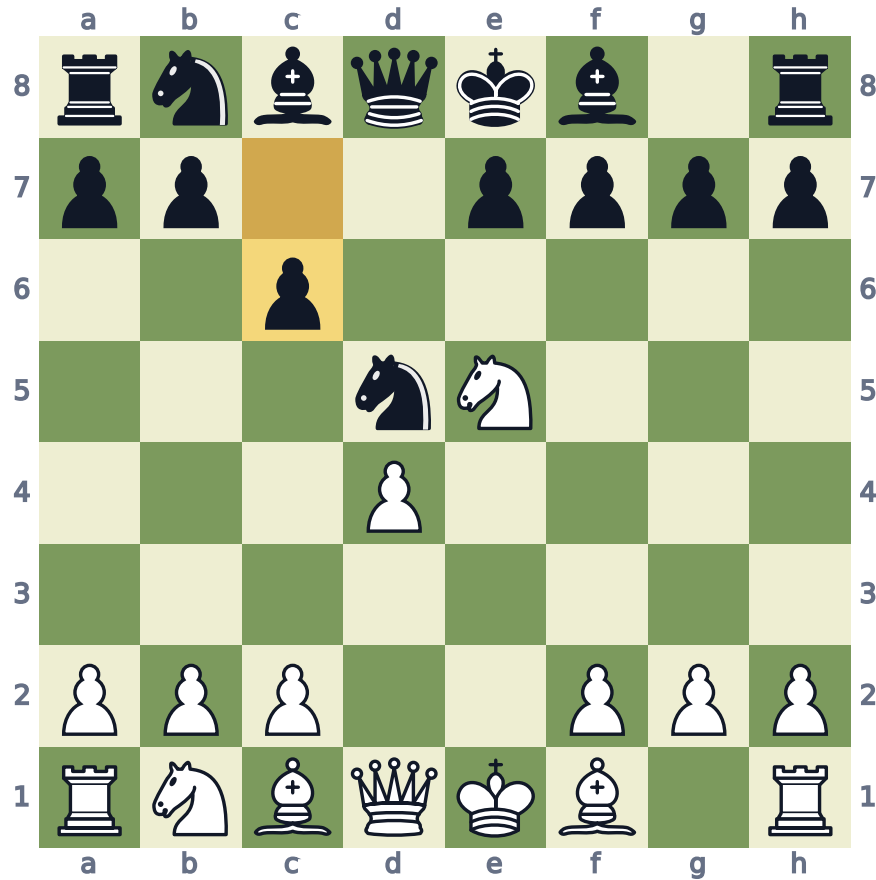
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Alekhine Modern



COURSE LINE

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Nf3 dxe5 5. Nxe5 c6

WHITE'S IDEA

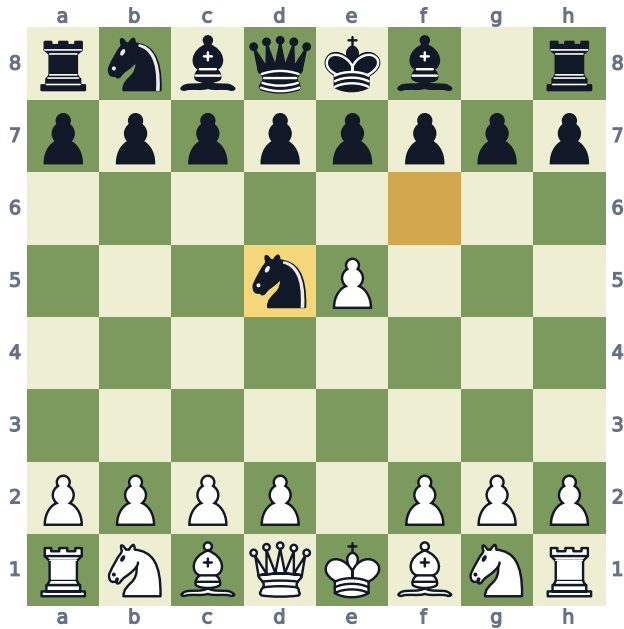
Use the space but support it with rapid development.

MAIN DANGER

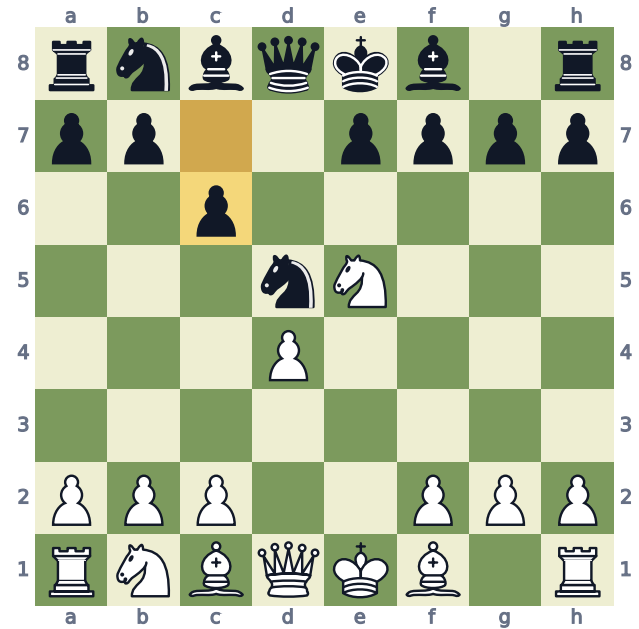
The e5 knight can be challenged and the d4 base attacked.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Nf3 develops before another pawn advance and keeps the center coordinated.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

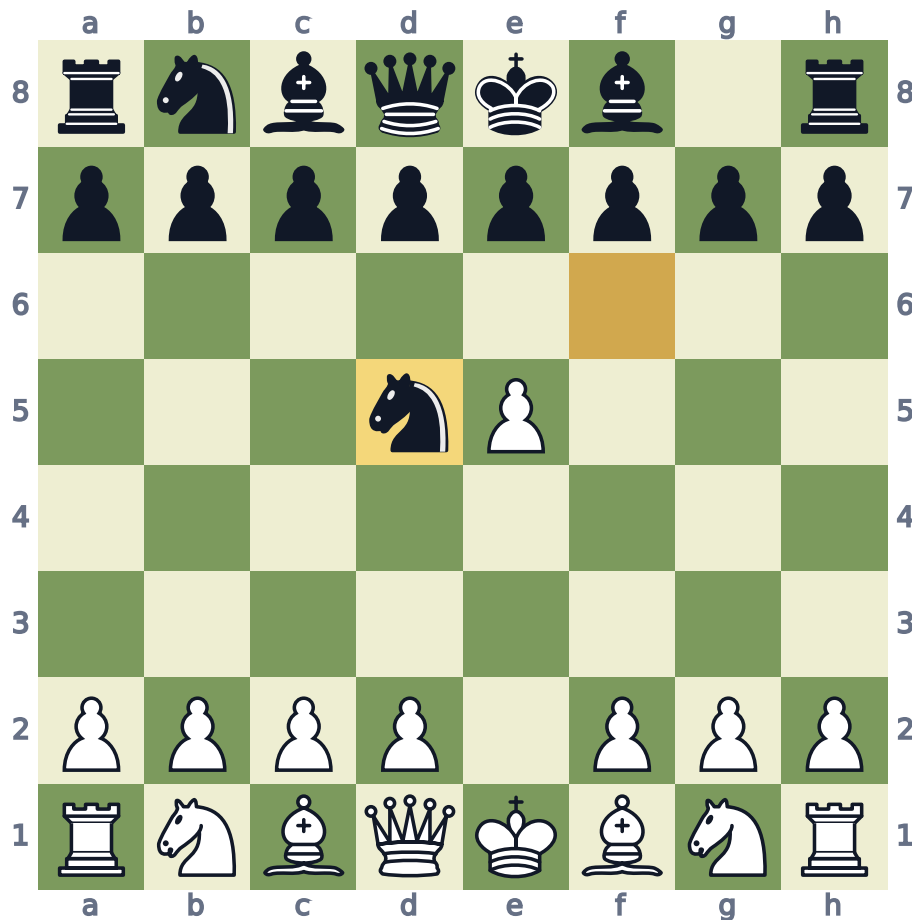
Position estimate: +0.67 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c4 Nc7 2. Be3 Nd7 3. Nf3 g6 4. Be2 Bg7 5. Nc3 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Alekhine Modern



YOUR TASK

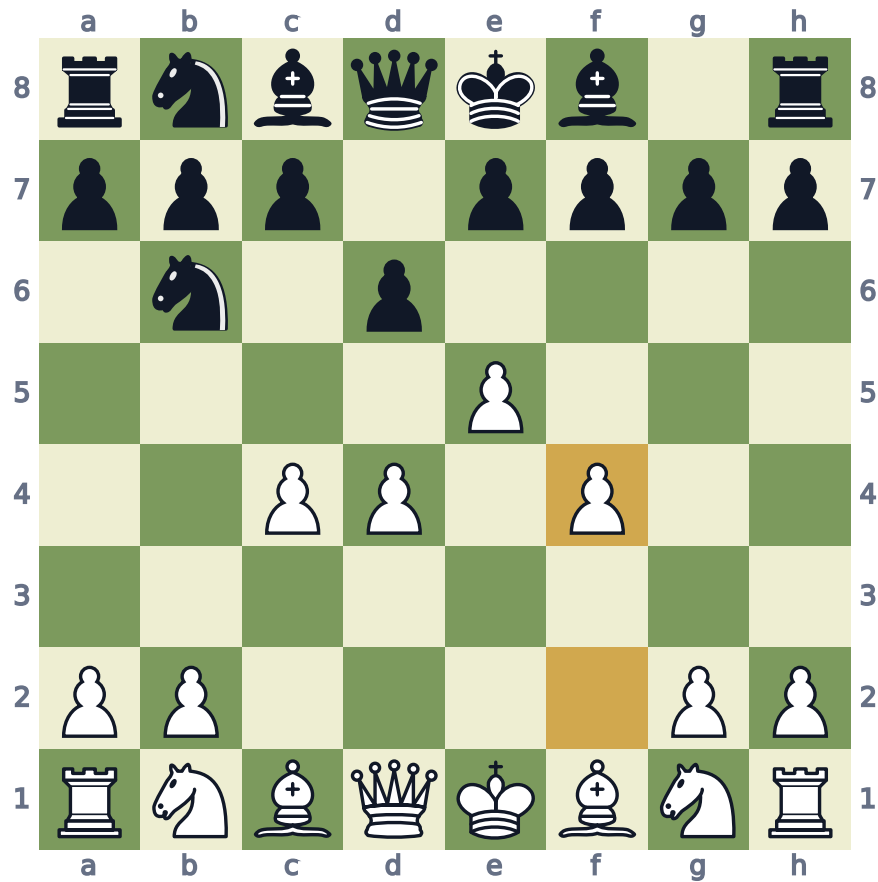
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Alekhine Four Pawns



COURSE LINE

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4

WHITE'S IDEA

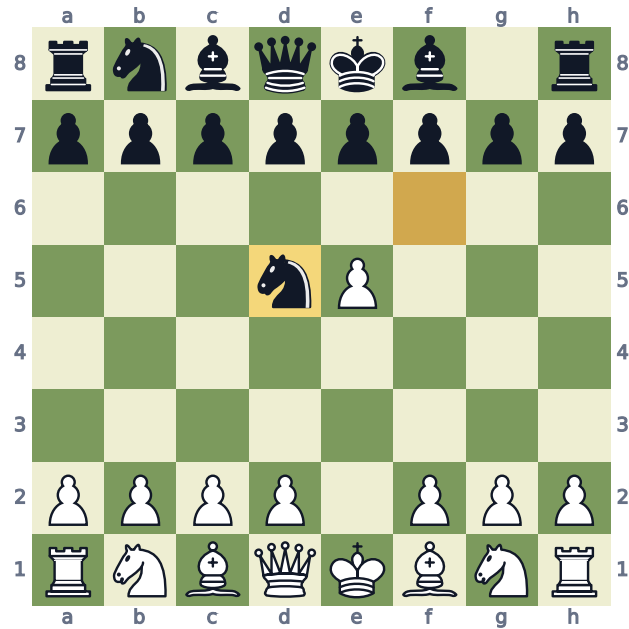
Understand the maximum-space option and its tactical responsibilities.

MAIN DANGER

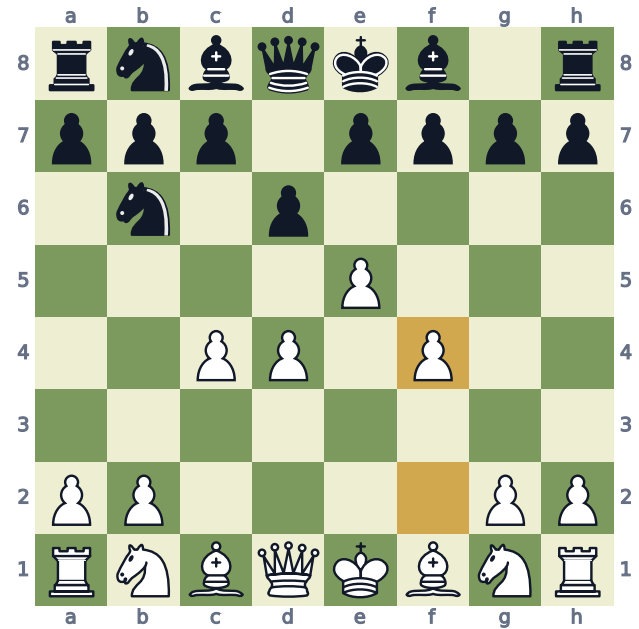
Four advanced pawns can become four targets.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Use this as a structure lesson; the Modern line is the safer main repertoire.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

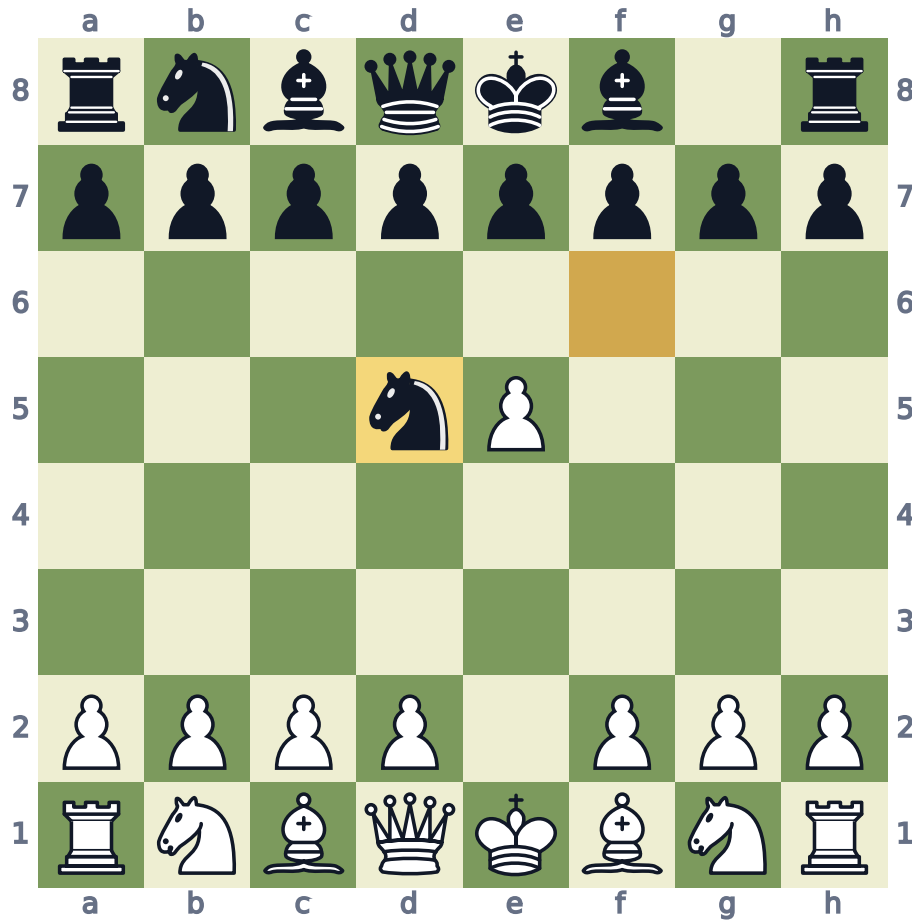
Position estimate: +0.58 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. dxe5 fxe5 2. Bf5 Nf3 3. e6 Nc3 4. Nc6 Be3 5. Bg4 Be2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Alekhine Four Pawns



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. SCANDINAVIAN ...QD8

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use the development tempo to build a healthy center and castle. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Qd8 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bc4 Bg7 4. O-O Nf6 5. Ne5 O-O (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Do not waste the gained tempo on unnecessary pawn moves.

02. SCANDINAVIAN ...QA5

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Develop while watching the pin on c3 and pressure on d4. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Qd8 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bc4 Bg7 4. O-O Nf6 5. Ne5 O-O (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen can support ...e5 or ...Bf5 with tactical pressure.

03. SCANDINAVIAN ...QD6

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Gain space and use natural development against the centralized queen. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Qd8 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bc4 Bg7 4. O-O Nf6 5. Ne5 O-O (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen may support ...e5 and kingside castling.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. MODERN SCANDINAVIAN

Course move: d4. Purpose: Build the center and gain time against the knight. Engine comparison: 1. d4 Nxd5 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 c5 4. d5 e6 5. Nf3 Bd6 (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: c4 creates d4 and dark-square obligations.

05. ICELANDIC GAMBIT

Course move: d4. Purpose: Return or keep material only while completing development and protecting the king. Engine comparison: 1. d4 Nxd5 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 c5 4. d5 e6 5. Nf3 Bd6 (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black's bishops and open lines give dangerous initiative.

06. PORTUGUESE GAMBIT

Course move: d4. Purpose: Question the bishop and keep the extra pawn flexible. Engine comparison: 1. d4 Nxd5 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 c5 4. d5 e6 5. Nf3 Bd6 (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: f3 weakens the king and e3 square.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. ALEKHINE MODERN

Course move: d4. Purpose: Use the space but support it with rapid development. Engine comparison: 1. d4 d6 2. c4 Nb6 3. exd6 cxd6 4. Nf3 g6 5. h3 Bg7 (+0.61 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The e5 knight can be challenged and the d4 base attacked.

08. ALEKHINE FOUR PAWNS

Course move: d4. Purpose: Understand the maximum-space option and its tactical responsibilities. Engine comparison: 1. d4 d6 2. c4 Nb6 3. exd6 cxd6 4. Nf3 g6 5. h3 Bg7 (+0.61 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Four advanced pawns can become four targets.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.